

Akamai warns of Iptables and IptabLex infection on Linux, and DDoS attacks

Akamai Technologies is a leading provider of cloud services for delivering, optimising



and securing online content and business applications. Through the company's Prolexic Security Engineering & Research Team (PLXsert), it has released a new cyber security threat advisory that alerts enterprises to a high-risk threat of Iptables and IptabLex infections on Linux systems. People with malicious intentions could use infected Linux systems to launch distributed denial of service (DDoS) attacks against the entertainment industry and other verticals.

DDoS botnet threat to Linux systems:

The mass infestation of Iptables and IptabLex seems to have been driven by a large number of Linux-based Web servers being compromised, mainly by exploiting Apache Struts, Tomcat and Elasticsearch vulnerabilities. Attackers have used the Linux vulnerabilities on unmaintained servers to gain access, escalate privileges to allow remote control of the machine, and then drop malicious code into the system and run it. As a result, a system can be controlled remotely as part of a DDoS botnet. A post-infection indication of an attack is a payload named .Iptables or .IptabLex located in the /boot directory. These script files run the .Iptables binary on reboot. The malware also contains a self-updating feature that causes the infected system to contact a remote host to download a file. In the lab environment, an infected system attempted to contact two IP addresses located in Asia.

Asia apparently a significant source of DDoS attacks: Command and control centres (C2, CC) for Iptables and IptabLex are currently located in Asia. Infected systems were initially known to be in Asia; however, more recently, many infections have been observed on servers hosted in the US and in other regions. In the past, most DDoS bot infections originated from Russia, but now Asia appears to be a significant source of such infections.

CALENDAR OF FORTHCOMING EVENTS

Name, Date and Venue	Description	Contact Details and Website
Gartner Symposium IT Xpo , October 14-17, 2014; Grand Hyatt, Goa	CIOs and senior IT executives from across the world will gather at this event, which offers talks and workshops on new ideas and strategies in the IT industry.	Website: http://www.gartner.com
Open Source India , November 7-8, 2014; NIMHANS Center, Bengaluru	Asia's premier open source conference that aims to nurture and promote the open source ecosystem across the sub-continent.	Omar Farooq: Email: omar.farooq@ofy.in ; Ph: 0995881062 http://www.osidays.com
CeBit November 12-14, 2014; BIEC, Bengaluru	This is one of the world's leading business IT events, and offers a combination of services and benefits that will strengthen the Indian IT and ITES markets.	Website: http://www.cebit-india.com/
5th Annual Datacenter Dynamics Converged , December 9, 2014; Riyadh	The event aims to assist the community in the datacentre domain by exchanging ideas, accessing market knowledge and launching new initiatives.	Praveen Nair: Email: Praveen.nair@datacenterdynamics.com ; Ph: +91 9820003158; Website: http://www.datacenterdynamics.com/
Hostingcon India December 12-13, 2014; NCPA, Jamshedji Bhabha Theatre, Mumbai	This event will be attended by Web hosting companies, Web design companies, domain and hosting resellers, ISPs and SMBs from across the world.	Website: http://www.hostingcon.com/contact-us/

Creator CI20. Imagination Technologies has launched an ISA developer board similar to the Raspberry Pi and BeagleBone Black SBCs. Creator is Imagination's new program, which will help it to provide low cost development systems for use to the open source community—to enthusiasts, hobbyists, cross-platform developers (i.e., Arduino), and partners looking to create applications using IP technologies. Creator CI20 SBC is powered by the 1.2GHz Ingenix JZ4780 system chip along with a PowerVR SGX540 GPU and 1GB of DDR3 RAM. It comes with 8GB of NAND flash storage as an option and an SD card slot for expandable memory support. The board comes with a 10/100 Ethernet port, Wi-Fi and Bluetooth connectivity, USB OTG support, a HDMI port and CMOS camera input. The board's dimensions are just 90.2mm x 95.3mm.



Mozilla Firefox 32 arrives with better SSL security features

Mozilla has announced the release of Firefox 32, which means users of the open source Web browser can now access new security fixes and features. Firefox 32 supports public-key pinning. This feature provides better security for Secure Sockets Layer (SSL) certificate authentication. The latest feature in the new version of Firefox combines with other mechanisms, which are used by Web browsers to enhance the integrity and authenticity of SSL certificates.

